C3 Unifying datasets

Shortcuts, mirroring (including Azure Databricks Unity Catalog) and avoiding duplicate copies.

C3-L1 OneLake shortcuts, and the delete that goes through

Shortcuts save copies. Treat every path under a shortcut as someone else's data.

What a shortcut is	A folder that points to data in OneLake or external storage, without copying it.
Delete the shortcut vs delete inside it	Deleting the shortcut keeps the data. Deleting files inside it deletes them in the target, if you can write there.
Shortcut as a table	Create it under Tables, pointing at Delta data.
External shortcut caching	OneLake caches read files for 1 to 28 days to cut egress.

C3-L2 Mirroring operational databases into OneLake

Mirroring replicates operational databases for free compute and generous storage, within per-source limits. Reconcile the table list after setup.

Shortcut or mirroring?	Shortcut for open-format data in storage. Mirroring for databases and catalogs, replicated when proprietary.
Mirroring cost	Replication compute is free. Storage is free up to 1 TB per CU. Queries use capacity.
Azure SQL Database mirroring limits	Up to 1,000 tables. Primary keys on datetime2(7), datetimeoffset(7) or time(7) block a table.
After setting up a mirror	Reconcile table lists and row counts with the source.

C3-L3 Mirroring Azure Databricks Unity Catalog into Fabric

Mirroring Unity Catalog copies no data and no permissions. Decide what is shareable, scope the connection, and rebuild access rules in Fabric.

What mirroring Unity Catalog moves	Only catalog metadata. Data is read in place through shortcuts.
Unity Catalog tables that do not mirror	Tables with row filters or column masks, federated, Delta Sharing and streaming tables, views and materialized views.
Unity Catalog permissions in Fabric	Not carried over. Rebuild access with Fabric's permission model.
Which identity reads mirrored data?	The connection's credential, for all queries. Scope it tightly.